# FLEET TEAM DIGEST

## 737MAX-FTD-32-26003

**Issue Title :** Cracked Main Gear Wheel Hub Cap Attach Lugs

| Airplane Model | ATA | Minor Model(s) |
|---|---|---|
| 737MAX | 3200-00 | -10, -7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ |

| Other Model(s) | ECCN |
|---|---|
| | 9E991 |

| Originated Date | Last Revised Date | Created On |
|---|---|---|
| 09/04/2026 | 09/04/2026 | 07/23/2026 |

| Estimated Completion Date | Next Update Date |
|---|---|
| | |

## Applicability

All 737NG/MAX airplanes

## Description

There have been numerous reports of cracks in the mounting lugs of plastic main gear wheel hub caps. Similar reports of cracks have also been received on 757 and 737CL airplanes using plastic hubcaps.

Most of the reports of cracking damage pertain to the inboard hubcap. Cracks can occur emanating from the mounting bolt holes, or in the transition area between the hubcap body and the mounting lugs.

Availability of spare inboard hubcap assembly P/N 277A6110-1 (made from hubcap P/N 277A6110-3) became critical in 2011 prompting Boeing to develop guidelines for operators who wished or needed to operate with cracked hubcaps.

## Status

The 737NG/MAX hubcap is made from a fiberglass reinforced epoxy compound and is attached to the wheel by three 1/4-28 bolts that install into threaded inserts in the wheel.

Boeing has examined several cracked hubcaps in our labs. Boeing found that the cracking is due to the fiberglass strands bunching-up at the top or bottom surface of the tab during the manufacturing process, leaving pockets of un-reinforced resin. The un-reinforced resin is prone to cracking, but we found that once the crack reaches the cross-linked fiberglass strands, the cracks arrest.

Boeing destructively tested several hubcaps with cracks in the transition area of the lugs and we found that due to the nature of the fiberglass strands at the bottom of the crack, it was very difficult to cause a tab to fully separate from the hubcap. Animated 'CAT' scans of cracked lugs show that there are sufficient cross-linked fiberglass strands in the transition areas to prevent complete tab separation under normal use.

Boeing has not received any reports of hubcaps with fully separated tabs.

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## Interim Action

Boeing has provided several operators with guidelines that allow them to operate with cracked hubcap assembly P/N 277A6110-1 as follows:

1) It is acceptable to use a hubcap with cracks in 1, 2, or all 3 bolt holes provided the bolt holes are repaired with bushings and/or the mounting bolts are installed with oversize outside diameter washers (such as an NASM970-4, AN970-4, or similar). Bushing repairs similar to that attached to this article can be provided upon request.

2) It is acceptable to use a hubcap with cracks in 1, 2, or all 3 tabs at the transition area.

3) It is acceptable to use hubcaps with cracks in both areas above simultaneously.

4) If a tab fully separates at the transition area, it must be discarded.

## Final Action

The correct torque range for all hubcap bolts is 80 +/- 2 in-lbs. The 737MAX AMM revision date of 15-Jan-2027 will reflect this information to help prevent over tightening of the bolts.

The first production run of inboard hubcaps with the improved fiberglass configuration was in early September 2015 for the 737NG fleet. The incorporation point for the improved hubcap is approximately airplane line number 5622, delivering in October 2015 and carried over to the 737MAX production lines.

Spare inboard hubcaps manufactured after September 2015 will also be of the improved configuration. No part number change was made.

## Milestones

**Note:** Target dates are based upon currently available status and have risk of future revision.

- Change Committed: 737MAX AMM Revision date 15-Jan-2027.

## Operator Action

Ensure that the hubcap mounting bolts are installed and tightened per the specified AMM procedure (do not overtighten bolts). Care should be taken to ensure that the hubcap is held fully seated against the wheel before tightening the bolts.

Inboard hubcaps with cracks can be used per the above guidelines indefinitely or until suitable spares are available.

Note: If hubcaps are required to be replaced, please refer to Boeing's 737NG/MAX Interchangeability drawing 277A6001 Rev T or latest revision letter. Boeing's interchangeability drawing contains a new Table 3F (inboard hubcap assembly) and Table 3G (outboard hubcap assembly) which shows approved hubcap assemblies for the 737MAX fleet.

## Reference Categories

| Reference Type | Reference Number | Revision Number | Reference Date |
|---|---|---|---|
| Maintenance Tip (MT) | 737-MT-32-017 | | |

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| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Aircraft Maintenance Manual (AMM) | 32-45-11/401 | | |
| Fleet Team Digest Article (FTD) | 737NG-FTD-32-07007 | | |

## Parts List

| Part Name | Boeing Part Number | Supplier Name | Supplier Number |
|---|---|---|---|
| Inboard Hubcap Assembly | 277A6110-1 | | |
| Inboard Hubcap | 277A6110-3 | | |
| Outboard Hubcap Assy | 277A6111-2, -3, -5, -7 | | |
| Outboard Hubcap | 277A6111-4, -6, -8 | | |

## Related Categories

- Airplane Maintenance Issues : Issues that occur during airplane maintenance or have an impact on airplane reliability
- AOGs : Events that cause a significant Airplane On Ground (AOG) condition
- Best Practices / Operational Efficiency : Operational / Maintenance-focused best practices, techniques, health checks or recommendations for preserving aircraft efficiency.
- Component Issues : Issues that occur during component maintenance or have an impact on component reliability

## Attachments:

a) hubcap_crack_location

b) cracked_hubcap

c) 737NG.MAX_Inboard_hubcap

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